My skill before and after teacher and cover plan

GROW Spring 1 Week 2 Wednesday 13 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Develop a skill and record it in my arts log.

Today: I can practise the same technique and compare my real before and after tests.

Success criteria

I can keep the same technique and test conditions.

I can practise, then keep an honest after test.

I can compare a feature and record my next step.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For five pupils: five books or arts logs, five pencils and fifteen small test spaces or sheets for before, practice and after records. Reuse books to avoid extra sheets.

Optional visual route: six drawing tools including the adult model. If using paint, use six brushes, five mats, three stable water pots, a small amount of familiar paint and cloths. Dry marks need no paint.

Quiet or silent route: fingertips or a small comfortable seated action. No instruments or recording device are required.

Adult model: a four-mark line or a four-action pattern, plus a visibly labelled original before and after demonstration. Keep the adult example separate from pupil evidence.

Retain each pupil's chosen technique, baseline and cue for the second period. An adult can make a precise dated observation note when writing materials are unavailable.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Show the labelled adult before test. Say: I keep this real starting point and the same four-part task.

15 to 30 seconds: Practise one feature slowly. Say: I keep my mark or action and use the same cue.

30 to 45 seconds: Show an actual matching adult after test. Say: I compare gaps or pace. I do not need to claim it is better.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to a specific feature. Say: This stayed similar. My next step is to practise the final gap. These are adult examples, not your evidence.

Arrival and starter

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Find your before test and chosen technique. Keep the same four-part test and cue.

What to say: Find the before test, goal and cue from Monday. We will keep the same technique and a similar size, pace guide and support. If the record is missing, make a fresh dated first test now. Do not invent an earlier result. If access requires a new form, keep the old record and make a new baseline for the new form.

What good looks like: The pupil recognises the chosen technique, test and cue. Any missing record, changed help or new access form is noted honestly before a comparison is planned.

Materials free fallback: Read back the adult witness note and let the pupil confirm the four-action pattern. If no reliable record exists, observe a fresh baseline today.

Check and response: Compare only matching tasks. A new baseline can still support useful learning today.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Point to one feature in your first test. Say your goal. Do not change the first record.

What to say: What does the real first test show about gaps or pace? Point to one feature. What was your small goal? We keep the first record exactly as it was so the comparison stays honest.

What good looks like: The pupil describes a specific starting feature without altering or improving the baseline. Staff distinguish the pupil's intention from the observed action.

Materials free fallback: Pupil confirms one feature from the spoken witness note. Use small gestures or direct the adult to show it.

Check and response: For example: The gap after mark two was smaller. My last action came sooner. Already steady is also a valid starting observation.

Modelling and cover guidance

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I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch one short practice step. See the same four-part test before and after. The after test can stay the same.

What to say: Here are two real adult model tests using the same mark, size and cue. I compare the gaps, not a new colour or the number of marks. For actions I keep the same four actions and slow cue, then compare their pace. I can say more even, about the same or more varied. I give one feature as my reason.

What good looks like: The adult demonstrates a fair comparison of the chosen feature and an honest outcome. The pupil sees that a changed art form or easier test cannot prove the original technique improved.

Materials free fallback: Describe two adult four-action examples or perform them silently. Say which feature is being compared. Label adult examples as models.

Check and response: Check: Which comparison is fair? A four marks before and ten after, B quiet taps before and a picture after, or C the same four-part test with similar conditions? C. If unclear, name the one feature and repeat matching examples.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Recover the real baseline, chosen technique, goal and cue. Keep the four-part test comparable. If no trustworthy baseline exists, make a fresh one with today's date before practice. Model a small practice step, allow two short rounds, then retain an honest matching after test and log. Use the same seven-stage timing. Private and silent routes remain valid.

Guided practice and making

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Try the chosen practice cue once. Ask for a comment about gaps or pace. Choose one next practice step.

What to say: Practise the same technique once. The listener says what they notice about the chosen feature. Hinge: after practice the result looks similar. Should we A pretend it improved, B record what is similar and choose a next step, or C hide the first test? Explain your choice.

What good looks like: The pupil selects B and gives a specific next practice action. Feedback describes gaps or pace and leaves the maker in control. The adult models only the first step when needed.

Materials free fallback: Use matching silent patterns or pupil-directed adult actions. An adult voices the observed feature and records the pupil's chosen next step.

Check and response: If A or C is chosen, model an unchanged outcome without blame. Parallel check: If the last action still comes early, can the log say that and plan another try? Yes. Continue when the pupil accepts an honest comparison.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: Practise your one technique in two short rounds. Use the same cue. Pause between rounds. Make the same four-part after test. Keep both tests.

What to say: Practise your small goal twice, with a calm pause. Then make the after test: the same four marks or actions, a similar scale or pace guide, the same cue and comparable help. Mark the actual date and label it after. Note any different support. Compare the chosen feature, even if it stayed similar or became less controlled.

What good looks like: A real after test follows practice and can be matched to the before record. The pupil identifies a feature, records actual support and gives an honest comparison. Adult help is visible, not presented as independent skill.

Materials free fallback: Observe the same four silent actions or pupil-directed adult sequence using the retained cue. Keep a dated witness note of before, after, support and the pupil's explanation. No device is needed.

Check and response: If form or support must change for access, explain it in the log. A new-form baseline and later matching test can show progress in that form, not a direct improvement claim over the old-form test.

Optional progression evidence

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Optional next level stretch

What to say: If you want the extra task, Use both tests to review your goal. Say what changed or stayed the same. Explain one comment you used or chose not to use. Set a next goal. Say how you will check it.

What good looks like: The pupil evaluates the chosen technique against their original goal, uses a specific feature as evidence, explains a feedback decision and proposes a fair next check.

Materials free fallback: Adult witnesses the matching live tests and records the same review prompts in the pupil's own confirmed words. No recorded media is required.

Retain: Keep both tests or witness notes, practice, your view and reasons, feedback and the next goal.

This task is extra. Your Explore work is complete without it. Keep the record in case your next level changes.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Compare your real before and after tests. What stayed the same? What changed? Choose one next step and store the records.

What to say: Look at or recall the two matching tests. Say one detail about the gaps or pace. It is fine to say unchanged, or that you need more practice. A partner may give a feature-based observation. Use the final two minutes to tidy, cap wet materials, keep work flat and store both tests with the log.

What good looks like: The pupil gives a reasoned comparison, accepts a truthful result and chooses a manageable next step. Private sharing is enough. The before and after records remain distinct.

Materials free fallback: Adult reads both precise observations aloud. Pupil confirms, corrects or adds their own view. Keep adult observation separate from pupil voice.

Check and response: Useful: Three gaps look more alike now. The last action still came early. I used more help today. Do not force better as the only valid answer.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: Before I ___. After I ___. I notice ___. My next step is ___. Say what help you used.

What to say: Record what the real evidence shows, your view and the support used. You can draw, speak, sign or use a scribe. I will read your words back. Your log shows chosen skill, practice and a before-and-after comparison. The next level task is optional.

What good looks like: A dated log links the same technique, two actual tests, practice, a feature-based view, support and next step. No award completion or guaranteed improvement is claimed.

Materials free fallback: Pupil confirms an oral or gestured comparison. Adult retains the real ordered tests and exact confirmed words in a dated witness note.

Check and response: Example only: Before, my final gap was short. After, it was still short. I kept a steady start. Next I will practise the last gap.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

Practice always makes the second version better. - Record what actually happened. It may improve, stay similar or need more practice. A clear observation is useful evidence.

More marks or faster taps show more skill. - The chosen target is control. Keep four marks or actions in the test and focus on the gaps or pace.

A fair before and after comparison can use completely different tasks. - Use the same chosen technique and four-part test. Keep similar conditions and note help. If access requires a new form, keep the old record and make a fresh baseline for that form.

A polished adult example can replace a pupil's first try. - Keep the pupil's real baseline, attempt and words. Label all adult samples as teacher models.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.